JASON CHOI
REAL ESTATE

FREE CHECKLIST

BUSINESS BUYER'S CHECKLIST

Buying a Business: Offer to Closing Checklist

A step-by-step checklist for buying a business in Alberta, with extra checklists for gas stations, restaurants, liquor stores and motels.



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Stage 1 — Before the Offer

☐	Item	Notes / date
☐	Sign a confidentiality agreement (NDA) to receive the information package	
☐	Get financing pre-approval or prepare proof of funds	
☐	Review the information package: financial summary, lease, equipment list	
☐	Talk to your accountant about asset purchase vs. share purchase	
☐	Decide your offer: price, deposit, how inventory is priced, training period	
☐	List your conditions: financing, due diligence, lease assignment, licences	
☐	Deliver the deposit to the brokerage or lawyer trust account	

Stage 2 — Due Diligence (Condition Period)

Financial

☐	Item	Notes / date
☐	3 years of financial statements and tax returns reviewed by your accountant	
☐	12 months of bank statements compared with reported sales	
☐	POS / sales reports and GST returns compared with revenue	
☐	Seller’s add-backs checked; owner earnings (SDE) recalculated	
☐	No unpaid suppliers, liens or CRA balances that could affect you	

Lease and Premises

☐	Item	Notes / date
☐	Full lease and all amendments reviewed by your lawyer	
☐	Landlord consent to assign the lease requested (allow 2–4 weeks)	
☐	Rent, operating costs and any arrears confirmed with the landlord	
☐	Premises and equipment inspected; repairs and deferred maintenance noted	

Legal and Licences

☐	Item	Notes / date
☐	Corporate search and personal property (PPR) lien search completed	
☐	Municipal business licence requirements confirmed	
☐	Industry licences identified (liquor, health, fuel, franchise) — see appendices	
☐	Employee list, wages and vacation owing reviewed	
☐	Supplier contracts and equipment leases reviewed for transfer	

Stage 3 — Removing Conditions

☐	Item	Notes / date
☐	Written financing commitment received	
☐	All due diligence issues resolved or price/terms renegotiated	
☐	Landlord’s written approval of the lease assignment received	
☐	Condition removal signed before the deadline — the deal is now firm	

Stage 4 — Before Closing

☐	Item	Notes / date
☐	Lawyers exchange closing documents and the statement of adjustments	
☐	Licence transfers or new applications filed	
☐	Utilities, internet, POS, alarm and insurance set up for the closing date	
☐	Inventory count booked (day before or morning of closing)	
☐	Plan agreed for telling staff (who, when, how)	
☐	Training and transition schedule confirmed in writing	

Stage 5 — Closing Day and After

☐	Item	Notes / date
☐	Inventory counted and priced; amount added to the statement of adjustments	

☐	Funds released; keys, codes and passwords handed over
☐	Licences posted in the new owner’s name; GST and payroll accounts opened
☐	Suppliers and customers notified of the new ownership
☐	Check-in with your REALTOR® at 1 week and 1 month

Appendix A — Gas Station

☐	Item	Notes / date
☐	Fuel supply agreement: brand, pricing, volume commitment, term, transfer rules	
☐	Phase I Environmental Site Assessment (Phase II if recommended); tank age, material and registration	
☐	Monthly fuel volume (litres) for 24+ months	
☐	Tank and line testing records; spill and incident history	
☐	Lottery, tobacco and propane licence transfers confirmed	

Appendix B — Restaurant

☐	Item	Notes / date
☐	Health inspection history reviewed; food establishment permit for the new owner arranged	
☐	Liquor licence class and transfer timeline with AGLC confirmed	
☐	Franchise (if any): transfer fee, training, franchisor approval	
☐	Hood and fire suppression inspection up to date; kitchen equipment tested	
☐	Key staff (chef, manager) retention discussed	

Appendix C — Liquor Store

☐	Item	Notes / date
☐	AGLC retail liquor licence application or transfer filed (background checks required)	
☐	Inventory count method agreed (at cost; counting service or manual)	
☐	Municipal separation-distance and zoning rules checked	

☐	Security systems, cameras and insurance requirements reviewed

Appendix D — Motel / Hotel

☐	Item	Notes / date
☐	Monthly occupancy, average daily rate (ADR) and RevPAR for 24+ months	
☐	Franchise brand: transfer rules and property improvement plan (PIP)	
☐	Building condition: roof, boilers, room heating/cooling units, parking lot	
☐	Tourism levy and GST filings reviewed	
☐	Manager's suite, staff housing and long-term guest arrangements confirmed	

Looking for a business to buy?
I help buyers find, evaluate and negotiate business purchases across Alberta and BC — including off-market opportunities. Call or text **(403) 399-8124**, email **CalgaryJason@gmail.com**, or visit **jasonchoirealestate.com**. English and 한국어.

This checklist is a practical guide only and is not legal, tax or environmental advice. Every business is different. Buyers should retain their own lawyer and accountant. Prepared by Jason Choi, REALTOR®, First Place Realty. Updated November 2026.